

TARU DHAWAN

Principal Technical Program Manager | Cloud Cost Governance | AI Infrastructure | Security and Reliability at Scale

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SUMMARY

Principal Technical Program Manager with 15+ years leading large-scale, cross-functional programs. Primary focus on cloud cost governance and capacity management for the Office and Copilot product group, with deep experience in AI program delivery and live-site operations. Uses data-driven decision making to work backward from customer and product outcomes, building frameworks that outlast the program: a cost governance model adopted across 10+ product organizations, an incident playbook born from customer-impacting outages, and AI-powered systems that fundamentally changed how engineering teams experience on-call. Drawn to problems that do not have a clear owner yet, leads by influence across organizational boundaries, and brings genuine intellectual curiosity to every problem from the architecture up.

EXPERIENCE

Principal Technical Program Manager 2021 – Present

Microsoft | Redmond, WA

Leading cloud cost governance and capacity programs for the Office and Copilot product group, reporting to a CVP and managing a team of 8 TPMs across 8 product organizations.

Cloud Cost Governance and Capacity Programs

- Delivered **\$40M in confirmed savings** against a \$42M target in FY26 by leading autoscale, SKU migrations, and efficiency-driven modernization and feature deprecations across Office products.
- Identified the absence of a reliable cost-per-session metric across Word, Excel, and PowerPoint as a gap in product investment decision-making; designed and built COGSWELL with a team of 3 engineers as the single source of truth on cloud spend, adopted by engineering leaders, finance, and leadership across the org. Later embedded an AI agent built in Copilot Studio to automate weekly reporting, anomaly alerting, and budget tracking, adopted by 15 COGS champions across Office products.
- Built Office Copilot feature economics framework: established a pre-launch cost, ROI, and quality review that served as the release gate for Copilot features, tying go/no-go decisions to business return across hundreds of services and accelerating decision velocity **3x**.
- Aligned 10+ product organizations under a shared cost governance framework covering compute, storage, and cloud services; framework adopted as the company-wide standard.
- Partnered with the Azure capacity team, who surfaced SKU options and utilization data, to right-size infrastructure across Office services; balanced SLA, latency, and availability tradeoffs to optimize spend without compromising service reliability.
- Secured 15 headcount approvals through structured investment proposals for FY26, spanning infrastructure migration and efficiency programs across product teams.

AI Programs and Live-Site Operations

- Built OASIS AI, a multi-agent live-site system, initially for Office Online, then drove adoption across the broader Office product group; partnered with Office engineering to orchestrate AI-driven incident triage and remediation, converting runbooks into executable workflows and reducing manual on-call remediation effort by up to **90%** across a 3,000-item backlog.
- Won back-to-back internal hackathons building AI-powered solutions, applying emerging AI and machine learning capabilities to real operational problems and advancing the team's thinking on what was possible with AI-driven automation.

Security Transformation

- Engaged a security architect to define the technical standard for managed identity adoption, then rallied engineering teams across 100+ services to execute against it, driving **~79% of Azure resources** to a secure-by-default posture.
- Automated rotation of 20,000+ certificates saving **~240,000 manual hours** and eliminated 2,300+ legacy credentials to reduce attack surface across cloud services.

Team Leadership and Organizational Impact

- Built and led a team of 8 technical program managers; owned end-to-end hiring, defined roles, and provided formal performance input and career development for 3 to 5 TPMs simultaneously.
- Moved teams toward shared goals across organizational boundaries without a formal reporting chain, aligning engineering, product, and design partners across 8 product teams to program outcomes.

Senior Technical Program Manager 2017 – 2021

Adidas North America | Portland, OR

- Led modernization of North American payments ecosystem across 300+ stores, including POS, mobile, and identity systems; reduced annual operating costs by **\$2M** while improving end-to-end customer experience at scale.
- Partnered with retail, engineering, and finance leadership to simplify system complexity across a distributed retail network.
- Introduced RFID-based inventory program achieving **99% inventory accuracy** and 98% shelf availability, improving product availability for customers across the retail network.

Senior Consultant, Business Intelligence 2015 – 2017

Daimler Truck | Portland, OR

- Built real-time factory dashboards reducing reporting latency by 60%; led big data platform migration and drove Agile adoption across manufacturing analytics teams.
- Translated complex technical requirements into actionable engineering plans, improving delivery predictability across cross-functional data and analytics teams.

SKILLS

Program Management: Cross-functional delivery, OKRs, risk management, release management, roadmap planning, executive communication, Agile

AI and Cloud: AI infrastructure, machine learning, multi-agent systems, Copilot Studio, Google AI Studio, cloud cost governance, capacity planning

Security and Reliability: Identity modernization, secrets management, certificate automation, service health, QA

Tools and Platforms: Azure, DevOps, Jira, Tableau, Confluence, Power BI

Leadership: Team building, hiring, career development, data-driven decision making, stakeholder alignment

EDUCATION

MBA, Marketing and Retail | SVKM's Narsee Monjee Institute of Management Studies, Mumbai, India

B.E., Computer Science and Engineering | Babu Banarsi Das Institute of Technology, Lucknow, India